He added that while Jaguar cars were ‘regaining the confidence of customers as being reliable’, the Land Rover was seeing a ‘resurgence in demand’ for its ‘current range of vehicles’. With the ‘market sentiment’ also improving in key markets such as the UK, the US and Europe, Ratan stated that the ‘outlook for Tata Motors’ appeared to be ‘robust’.

In September 2010, Tata Motors unveiled the Land Rover’s all-new Range Rover Evoque at the Paris Motor Show. The smallest car thus far from the Range Rover stable, it defined a ‘new segment for premium compact SUVs’ that was more ‘sporting and stylish’. A ‘real [game-changer] in the SUV sector’, the Evoque received a ‘tremendous response’ and became an instant hit, with cars being shipped all the way to China, Hong Kong, Italy, the US and Australia.

Shailesh Chandra, president of electric mobility and corporate strategy, Tata Motors, says that the shifting of the Evoque to the Range Rover stable was a move personally made by Ratan. It made all the difference to the car, which used to sell limited numbers under the Land Rover brand. The change made a substantial difference to JLR’s profitability.

One of the most prominent appreciators of JLR’s turnaround was UK Prime Minister Gordon Brown. On hearing that Ratan would retire in 2012, he wrote to him stating, ‘Your quiet and dignified contribution not just to India and Asia but to Britain—and to the world economy—is held in the highest esteem. I hope there will be an opportunity to acknowledge that extraordinary public service for which we owe you a deal of gratitude.’

Brown was particularly impressed by the new business and employment opportunities JLR brought to the UK. By 2014, JLR had already hired about ‘8,000 new workers in the last two years’ to meet its burgeoning demand. It also planned to ‘spend an additional £1m with UK suppliers of components for the Range Rover Evoque’.

The success of the two brands also saw ‘some £3 bn worth of contracts to UK suppliers during the last 16 months alone’. Brown wrote again to Ratan saying, ‘Your plan to bring some “40 significant product actions” to the market over a five-year period, with much of the innovation work in design, engineering and technology set to be done in the UK, is exciting and path-breaking.’

By February 2011, JLR was well on its way to making a £1 billion profit for FY 2010–11, ‘sealing one of the most extraordinary industrial turnarounds in recent British corporate history’, as *The Times* commented.